Final Creative Project

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CCT417 Alternative Media

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Object — Poster



Figure 1. Background of poster



Figure 2. Two-side icon layout: harmful behaviors vs. eco-friendly actions



Figure 3. Front side of poster: sad Earth with environmentally harmful behaviors



Figure 4. Reverse side of poster: smiling Earth with eco-friendly actions

Rationale

This project is an interactive environmental protection poster titled “LET’S SAVE THE WORLD TOGETHER.” Unlike traditional static posters, this project incorporates an interactive mechanism. Viewers can physically participate in conveying the environmental protection message while engaging with the work.

The poster has two sides. On the front side, the Earth displays a sad expression, with six icons representing common environmentally harmful behaviors, each featuring a red cross mark in the upper right corner, such as using plastic bags, driving private cars, cutting down trees and so on. On the back side, the Earth changes to a smiling expression, and the icons in the same positions are flipped to reveal corresponding eco-friendly actions, each featuring a green check mark in the upper right corner, such as using reusable shopping bags, choosing low-carbon transportation, participating in tree planting and so on.

The icons are fixed with magnetic cards, which enable viewers to flip them by hand, transforming “non-environmentally friendly” behaviors into “environmentally friendly” ones. This simple action visually demonstrates the effect of “change,” and also symbolizes the process of improving the environment in real life by adjusting one’s behavior. The blue information box at the bottom provides brief explanations and practical suggestions for each eco-friendly action. Helping viewers understand their significance and offering feasible daily solutions. The interactive feature is achieved by magnetic cards, and it is suitable for schools and community events. During the interaction, viewers simulate real-life behavioral choices, and conveying the message that every choice they make can change the Earth.

In terms of target audience, this poster is designed for children and students aged from 5 to 18, and their family members. Since younger people's habits and environmental awareness are still forming, it is easier to guide them toward positive changes. The clear red cross and green check marks make it easy for younger viewers to immediately distinguish harmful actions from beneficial ones, even if they cannot fully read the text, thus lowering the age barrier for understanding. Also, when children engage in this poster, they often want to share their experience with parents, which draws adults' attention to environmental issues as well. This intergenerational influence helps promote sustainable practices within households, and extending the poster's impact beyond young audiences to entire families.

As an alternative media, this interactive environmental protection poster functions in three main ways. First, it bypasses mainstream communication channels such as television advertising and commercial billboards, try to reaches the public directly in schools and communities. This method avoids the filtering or commercial packaging of information by corporations and governments. Preserve the integrity and critical nature of the message. As Eichhorn (2016, p.116) explains, photocopying was valued by social movements because it allowed for uncensored communication. This poster follows the same idea by keeping the message direct and unaltered.

Second, the interactive design of the poster allows viewers to flip magnetic cards, and replace environmentally harmful behaviors to eco-friendly ones. This transforms viewers from passive recipients into active participants. This model is similar to what Darder (2011, p.700) describes in the context of community radio, where audiences are not merely information receivers but also co-creators and distributors of content. During the interaction, viewers often

will take photos or videos and share them on social platforms, such as Instagram and TikTok, and they will create a spontaneous network for spreading environmental messages. This participant-driven approach breaks the one-way communication model of media, extending the reach of the message. As Cozen (2013, p. 301) points out, the Green Patriot Posters project encourages broad community involvement through open submissions and public dissemination. Which may help environmental messages travel farther and endure longer.

Finally, this interactive form transforms abstract environmental concepts into actionable daily practices, narrowing the gap between advocacy and the public. Through participatory communication in public spaces, this poster provides public a platform for expression and discussion. Bringing environmental issues into daily life and inspiring broader social participation and collective action. As Cozen (2013, p. 310) explains, artistic practices can reshape how individuals understand and engage with the world by reworking familiar structures and meanings. This poster supports that goal by translating abstract environmental concerns into small, everyday actions that invite public participation.

In conclusion, this interactive poster is a powerful example of alternative media. It avoids mainstream control, involves the audience, and connects big ideas with daily choices. By focusing on young people and their families, it builds a wider base for environmental awareness. Through creativity and hands-on interaction, it invites people not only to think about change but also to make it happen.

Bibliography

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